Ben Lalor

Building energy codes specialist. Full-stack developer. Denver, Colorado

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Summary

Building energy codes specialist and full-stack developer with 12 years of experience as a Title 24 Part 6 subject matter expert. I build tools, training, and resources for Title 24 stakeholders, and I support development of future versions of energy codes and standards such as California's Energy Code (Title 24 Part 6) and the Washington State Energy Code (WSEC). I am an early adopter of generative AI since 2022, applying it across software development, energy modeling, and knowledge workflows. I am the founder of Wattly, Title 24 BEM and Energy Code compliance software covering performance and prescriptive compliance, currently awaiting CEC certification for the 2025 Energy Code.

Experience

NORESCO

2019 to present

Senior Energy Analyst, 2024 to present. Energy Analyst III, 2021 to 2024. Energy Analyst II, 2019 to 2021.

- Lead an interdisciplinary team of software developers and subject matter experts to build the Virtual Compliance Assistant, a Title 24 Part 6 form completion tool.
- Develop and maintain data pipelines in AWS used to inform future policy decisions for building energy codes, including a secure API for large-scale building data.
- Develop and maintain the XSD ruleset used as shared infrastructure for Energy Code compliance tools in the state of California.
- Build tools, training, and resources for Title 24 stakeholders for the Energy Code Ace platform.
- Support development of future versions of energy codes and standards such as California's Energy Code (Title 24 Part 6) and the Washington State Energy Code (WSEC) as a Codes and Standards Enhancement (CASE) subject matter expert for Title 24 Part 6 code development in the 2022, 2025, and 2028 cycles.
- Work with the California Energy Commission (CEC), local governments, IOUs, and CPUC Codes and Standards participants to support energy code compliance. Support local governments on Reach Code adoption.
- Manage a team of direct reports, including career development and growth. Delegate workload, provide feedback, and lead internal trainings on relevant subject matters such as building science, software development, and AI tooling.

EnergySoft

2014 to 2019

Energy Analyst, 2015 to 2019. Intern, 2014 to 2015.

- Built building energy models for nonresidential projects including Apple Park.
- Developed life-cycle cost analyses of nonresidential design options in EnergyPro.
- Managed a team of energy consultants.

Industry engagement

- ACEEE Summer Study 2024 paper and talk. 21st Century Compliance: Data-Driven Solutions for Decarbonization and Equity, with Sally Blair and Jill Marver. Paper PDF · Proceedings
- CalBEM 2025 Power Talk. Capturing the Value of BEM Data for Policy and Programs.
- CABEC 2024. California Energy Code compliance software framework.
- CABEC 2022. What is new with the 2022 Nonresidential energy code.
- CABEC 2026. AI for Energy Consultants. Presentation
- Technical briefing for CEC Commissioner Andrew McAllister and senior staff on the NORESCO Codes and Standards database.

Wattly

Founder. Title 24 BEM and Energy Code compliance software for California, covering performance and prescriptive compliance. Currently awaiting CEC certification for the 2025 Energy Code. Releasing in private beta. wattlysolutions.com

Education

- B.S. Energy Management and Design, Sonoma State University. Thermal energy management, renewable energy systems, electrical energy management.
- B.S. Computer Science, Colorado State University. Software development, databases, software engineering, computer architecture.

Skills

Domain: Title 24 Part 6 and Part 11, WSEC, BEM, prescriptive and performance compliance, CASE, Reach Codes, EnergyPro, CBECC, Wattly, OpenStudio, EnergyPlus.

Software: JavaScript, React, Python, C#, .NET, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Azure, AWS, Git, Django, Cursor.